

VOLUNTEER

1. Passage anchor

> “Later, he began ****volunteering at a community centre**** on weekends.”

Passage meaning

****volunteer**** = freely give one’s time and effort to help an organization, cause, or people, usually without being paid

****做義工；從事志願服務****

Here, Kelvin chooses to spend his weekends helping at a community centre without doing it as a paid job.

Practice

1. She ****volunteers at a hospital**** every Saturday.

她每個星期六都在醫院****做義工****。

2. Many students ****volunteer in the community****.

很多學生都會在社區****從事志願服務****。

Core meanings of VOLUNTEER

2. volunteer — do unpaid work willingly

As a verb:

= freely offer one’s time and effort to help without being forced, usually without pay

****做義工；自願服務****

Examples

1. He ****volunteers**** at a local charity.

他在本地慈善機構****做義工****。

2. She ****volunteered**** throughout the summer.

她整個夏天都在****做志願服務****。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. volunteer at / with an organization

= work voluntarily for a particular organization

在某機構做義工

Examples

1. She **volunteers at** a community centre.
她在社區中心**做義工**。

2. He **volunteers with** a youth charity.
他在一個青年慈善機構**擔任義工**。

4. volunteer for a cause / organization

= give one's time willingly to support a cause or organization

為某事業 / 機構做義工

Examples

1. Hundreds of people **volunteered for** the charity.
數百人自願為那家慈善機構**提供服務**。

2. She **volunteered for** an environmental project.
她自願參與一個環保專案。

Volunteer for a task

5. volunteer for something

= offer to take on a task, duty, activity, etc. willingly

自願承擔；主動報名參加

Examples

1. He **volunteered for the difficult task**.
他**自願承擔**那項艱難任務。

2. Several students **volunteered for cleanup duty**.
幾名學生**主動報名**做清潔工作。

This does not necessarily mean unpaid charity work.

6. volunteer to do something

= offer to do something without being asked or forced

自告奮勇做某事；主動提出做某事

Examples

1. She **volunteered to help**.

她**主動提出幫忙**。

2. He **volunteered to drive** everyone home.

他**自告奮勇開車**送大家回家。

Very high-value construction.

Noun: person who volunteers

7. volunteer — unpaid helper

As a noun:

= person who willingly works for an organization or cause without pay

義工；志願者

Examples

1. The centre depends on **volunteers**.

這個中心依靠**義工**運作。

2. She works there as a **volunteer**.

她在那裡擔任**義工**。

8. community volunteer

= person who freely helps in their local community

社區義工；社區志願者

Examples

1. He became a regular **community volunteer**.
他成了一名固定的**社區義工**。
2. **Community volunteers** helped elderly residents.
社區義工幫助了年長居民。

Offer information without being asked

9. volunteer information

= give information freely without being asked directly
主動提供資料 / 資訊

Examples

1. She **volunteered the information** before anyone asked.
還沒有人問，她就**主動提供了資料**。
2. He **volunteered his name and address**.
他**主動說出了自己的姓名和地址**。

Distinct transitive verb sense.

10. volunteer that...

= say something voluntarily, especially without being asked
主動補充說；主動透露

Examples

1. He **volunteered that** he had seen the incident.
他**主動補充說**自己目睹了事件。
2. She **volunteered that** she was available the next day.
她**主動表示**第二天有空。

More formal than ordinary **say**.

Military sense

11. volunteer — person who joins military service willingly

= person who freely chooses to join military service rather than being forced or conscripted

志願兵；自願參軍者

Examples

1. He joined the army as a **volunteer**.

他以**志願兵**身分加入軍隊。

2. The unit included both conscripts and **volunteers**.

該部隊同時有徵召兵和**志願兵**。

12. volunteer for military service

= freely offer to serve in the armed forces

自願從軍；自願服兵役

Examples

1. Thousands **volunteered for military service**.

數千人**自願從軍**。

2. He **volunteered** during the war.

他在戰爭期間**自願參軍**。

Adjective use

13. volunteer — done/provided by volunteers

As an adjective before a noun:

= involving or carried out by people working voluntarily

義務的；由志願者進行的

Examples

1. She does **volunteer work** on weekends.

她週末會做**義工工作**。

2. The town has a **volunteer fire department**.

該鎮有一支**志願消防隊**。

14. volunteer organization / group

= organization whose activities depend largely on volunteers

****志願組織；義工團體****

Examples

1. The service is run by a ****volunteer organization****.
這項服務由一個****志願組織****營運。
2. Several ****volunteer groups**** helped after the storm.
風暴後有幾個****義工團體****提供協助。

Volunteer work

15. volunteer work

= unpaid work done willingly to help others, a cause, or an organization

****義工工作；志願服務****

Examples

1. ****Volunteer work**** can build useful skills.
****義工工作****可以培養實用技能。
2. He included his ****volunteer work**** on his résumé.
他把自己的****義工經驗****寫進履歷。

16. volunteer experience

= experience gained through unpaid voluntary work

****義工經驗；志願服務經驗****

Examples

1. She has extensive ****volunteer experience****.
她有豐富的****義工經驗****。
2. The role values previous ****volunteer experience****.

這個職位重視過往的**志願服務經驗**。

VOLUNTARY

17. voluntary — done by choice

= done because one chooses to do it, not because one is forced

自願的；自發的

Examples

1. Participation is completely **voluntary**.

參與完全是**自願的**。

2. The program is **voluntary**.

這個計畫屬於**自願參加**。

Major related family word.

18. voluntary work

= work done willingly without compulsion and usually without pay

志願工作；義務工作

Examples

1. She does **voluntary work** for a charity.

她為慈善機構做**志願工作**。

2. The students completed several hours of **voluntary work**.

學生完成了數小時的**義務工作**。

19. voluntary donation / contribution

= donation or contribution given by choice rather than obligation

自願捐款；自願貢獻

Examples

1. Entry is free, but **voluntary donations** are welcome.

入場免費，但歡迎**自願捐款**。

2. The fund depends on **voluntary contributions**.
該基金依靠**自願捐款**。

20. voluntary resignation / departure

= resignation or departure made by one's own choice
自願辭職；自願離開

Examples

1. The company offered a **voluntary resignation** scheme.
公司推出**自願離職**方案。
2. His departure was entirely **voluntary**.
他的離開完全是**自願的**。

VOLUNTARILY

21. voluntarily

= willingly and by one's own choice
自願地；主動地

Examples

1. She **voluntarily** gave up the role.
她**自願**放棄了這個職位。
2. He came forward **voluntarily**.
他**主動**站出來。

INVOLUNTARY

22. involuntary

= not done by choice; automatic or forced
非自願的；不由自主的

Examples

1. The movement was ****involuntary****.
那個動作是****不由自主的****。

2. His departure was ****involuntary****.
他並非****自願離開****。

Important opposite family member.

23. involuntarily

= without intending or choosing to
****不由自主地；非自願地****

Examples

1. She ****involuntarily**** stepped back.
她****不由自主地****退後一步。

2. He ****involuntarily**** laughed.
他****忍不住 / 不由自主地****笑了。

Volunteerism

24. volunteerism

= practice or principle of people freely giving time and effort to help others or the community
****志願服務精神；義工文化****

Examples

1. The organization promotes ****volunteerism**** among young people.
該組織在年輕人中推廣****志願服務精神****。

2. The city has a strong culture of ****volunteerism****.
這座城市有濃厚的****義工文化****。

Useful social/community family noun.

Voluntarism

25. voluntarism

More formal:

= principle that activities, services, or actions should depend on voluntary participation rather than compulsion

****自願原則；志願主義****

In philosophy, ****voluntarism**** can also refer to theories emphasizing the will.

This is much more formal/specialist than ****volunteerism**** and lower priority for general learners.

Gardening / botany

26. volunteer — self-seeded plant

In gardening/agriculture:

= plant that grows without being deliberately planted, usually from seeds left from an earlier crop or dispersed naturally

****自生植物；自行長出的植物****

Examples

1. A tomato ****volunteer**** appeared beside the compost pile.

堆肥旁長出了一株****自生番茄****。

2. We left several ****volunteer plants**** in the garden.

我們把幾株****自行長出的植物****留在花園裡。

A genuine domain-specific noun sense.

27. volunteer plant

= plant growing without intentional planting

****自生植物****

Examples

1. This sunflower is a ****volunteer plant****.

這株向日葵是**自行長出來的植物**。

2. **Volunteer plants** may come from seeds dropped the previous year.
自生植物可能來自前一年掉落的種子。

Volunteer fire service

28. volunteer firefighter

= firefighter who serves voluntarily rather than as a full-time salaried professional
志願消防員

Examples

1. He serves as a **volunteer firefighter**.
他擔任**志願消防員**。
2. The area relies heavily on **volunteer firefighters**.
該區非常依賴**志願消防員**。

High-value constructions

29. volunteer one's time

= freely give time to help
自願付出時間；貢獻時間做義工

Examples

1. Many parents **volunteer their time** at the school.
很多家長都**自願付出時間**幫助學校。
2. She **volunteered her time** to help elderly residents.
她**自願貢獻時間**幫助長者。

30. volunteer one's services

= offer one's skills or work freely
主動提供服務

Examples

1. Several doctors ****volunteered their services****.
幾位醫生****主動提供專業服務****。

2. He ****volunteered his services**** as a driver.
他****主動提出擔任司機****。

31. volunteer someone else

Informal/humorous:

= nominate another person for a task without their asking
****替別人自作主張報名 / 推舉****

Examples

1. Don't ****volunteer me**** for that job!
別****擅自替我報名****做那件事！

2. She ****volunteered her brother**** to carry the boxes.
她擅自把哥哥****推去負責搬箱子****。

Usually humorous because true volunteering is supposed to be voluntary.

Key contrasts

32. volunteer vs work

****work****

= broad activity done as a job or to accomplish something
****工作****

****volunteer****

= freely give time/effort, usually without pay
****做義工；志願服務****

Compare:

- > She works at the hospital.
- > 她在醫院工作，可能受薪。

> She volunteers at the hospital.
> 她在醫院做義工，通常沒有薪酬。

33. volunteer vs unpaid worker

****unpaid worker****

= simply describes someone who receives no pay

****無薪工作者****

****volunteer****

= emphasizes that the person ****chose willingly**** to offer help

****義工；志願者****

Not every unpaid worker is necessarily a volunteer.

34. volunteer vs charity worker

****volunteer****

= may help any nonprofit, community group, event, institution, emergency service, etc.

****義工****

****charity worker****

= someone working for a charity; may be paid or unpaid

****慈善機構工作人員****

So a charity worker is not automatically a volunteer.

35. volunteer vs offer

****offer****

= say that you are willing to give/do something

****提出；願意提供****

****volunteer****

= offer oneself, one's time, information, or effort without being asked

****自告奮勇；主動提出****

Compare:

> She offered to help.

> 她提出幫忙。

> She volunteered to help.

> 她**自告奮勇**幫忙。

****Volunteer**** more strongly emphasizes initiative.

36. volunteer vs participate

****participate****

= take part in an activity

****參與****

****volunteer****

= willingly offer to take part or help, often unpaid

****自願參與；做義工****

You can participate in something without volunteering.

37. volunteer vs voluntary

****volunteer****

can be:

* noun → ****義工 / 志願者****

* verb → ****自願提供 / 做義工****

* adjective → ****由義工進行的****

****voluntary****

= adjective meaning ****done by choice rather than force****

Compare:

> volunteer worker

> 義工

> voluntary participation

> 自願參與

38. voluntary vs optional

****voluntary****

= not compulsory; done by free choice

****自願的****

****optional****

= available as a choice but not required

****可選擇的；非必須的****

Compare:

> participation is voluntary

> 參與與否由你自行決定

> dessert is optional

> 甜品可以選擇要或不要

They overlap but are not identical.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****volunteer**** is:

****doing or offering something by free choice rather than because one is forced****

From this develop several branches.

A. Community service

Passage

volunteer at a community centre

→ ****在社區中心做義工****

Noun

a volunteer

→ ****義工 / 志願者****

Activity

volunteer work

→ ****義工工作****

B. Offer oneself for a task

Task

volunteer for a job

→ **自願承擔任務**

Action

volunteer to help

→ **自告奮勇幫忙**

C. Offer information

Speech

volunteer information

→ **主動提供資料**

Clause

volunteer that...

→ **主動補充說.....**

D. Military

Person

military volunteer

→ **志願兵**

E. Gardening

Plant

volunteer plant

→ **自行生長的自生植物**

The broader family then emphasizes free choice:

> ****voluntary****

> → 自願的

> ****voluntarily****

> → 自願地

> ****involuntary****

> → 非自願的 / 不由自主的

> ****volunteerism****

> → 志願服務文化 / 精神

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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volunteer — unpaid service verb	自願付出時間和勞力幫助他人 / 機構，通常不收報酬；做義工
volunteer at/with an organization	在某機構 / 與某組織一起做義工
volunteer for a cause/organization	自願為某事業 / 機構提供服務
volunteer for a task	主動報名 / 自願承擔某項任務
volunteer to do something	沒有被迫或要求而自告奮勇做某事
volunteer — noun helper	自願提供無薪服務的人；義工 / 志願者
community volunteer	在社區提供志願服務的社區義工
volunteer information	沒有人要求便主動提供資料 / 資訊
volunteer that...	主動補充 / 透露某項資訊
volunteer — military noun	自願加入軍隊而非被徵召的志願兵
volunteer for military service	自願從軍 / 服兵役
volunteer — adjective	由志願者進行、提供的
volunteer work	自願且通常無薪的義工工作 / 志願服務
volunteer experience	參與義工服務所累積的經驗
voluntary	因自己選擇而做、並非被強迫的；自願的
voluntary work	自願進行、通常無薪的志願工作
voluntary donation/contribution	並非強制、由個人自行決定的捐款 / 貢獻
voluntarily	出於自己意願地；自願地
involuntary	並非出於自己意願的；非自願 / 不由自主的
involuntarily	不由自主地；非自願地
volunteerism	鼓勵人們自願服務社會的志願服務精神 / 文化
voluntarism	較正式：強調自願參與的原則 / 志願主義
volunteer — plant	沒有人刻意種植而自行長出的自生植物

volunteer plant	由自然散落種子等自行生長的植物	
volunteer firefighter	自願提供消防服務的志願消防員	
volunteer one's time	主動付出自己的時間幫助他人	
volunteer one's services	主動提供自己的技能 / 服務	
volunteer someone else	非正式 / 幽默：擅自替別人報名承擔某事	

Passage recap

> “Later, he began **volunteering at a community centre** on weekends.”

Here:

volunteer = **to willingly give one's time and effort to help an organization or people, usually without pay**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **做義工**

* **從事志願服務**

* **自願幫忙**

Natural contextual translation:

後來，他開始在週末到社區中心做義工。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

volunteer

= **to freely offer one's time and effort to help others or an organization, usually without being paid**

做義工；從事志願服務

The biggest learner splits are:

> **volunteer at a community centre**

> → **在社區中心做義工**

> **volunteer to help**

> → **自告奮勇幫忙**

> **volunteer for the task**

> → **自願承擔那項任務**

> ****volunteer information****

> → ****主動提供資料****

> ****a volunteer****

> → ****義工 / 志願者****

> ****military volunteer****

> → ****志願兵****

and in gardening:

> ****volunteer plant****

> → ****自行長出的自生植物****

The related adjective also matters:

> ****voluntary participation****

> → ****自願參與****

while:

> ****involuntary movement****

> → ****不由自主的動作****

So in the passage, ****volunteer**** uses the community-service branch: Kelvin deliberately chooses to give his time helping others, which also reinforces the passage's larger contrast between his former behavior and his growing maturity.